

Diabetes Patient Guidelines

Managing diabetes requires a balanced approach to diet, exercise, sleep, and medication. These lifestyle choices play a crucial role in maintaining stable blood sugar levels and reducing the risk of complications. The following guidelines provide a foundation for daily care.

1. Diet

- Focus on whole grains, vegetables, fruits, lean proteins, and healthy fats.
- Avoid refined sugars, processed foods, and sugary drinks.
- Maintain portion control and eat smaller, balanced meals throughout the day.
- Monitor carbohydrate intake and pair carbs with proteins or healthy fats.
- Stay hydrated and limit alcohol consumption.

2. Exercise

- Aim for at least 150 minutes of moderate physical activity per week (e.g., brisk walking, cycling).
- Include strength training exercises 2–3 times a week to improve insulin sensitivity.
- Avoid long periods of sitting; take breaks every 30–60 minutes.
- Consult with a doctor before starting new exercise routines.

3. Sleep Cycle

- Maintain 7–9 hours of quality sleep per night.
- Go to bed and wake up at consistent times daily.
- Avoid caffeine and heavy meals before bedtime.
- Create a calm, dark, and comfortable sleep environment.
- Poor sleep can increase insulin resistance and affect blood sugar levels.

4. Medication

- Take prescribed medications (oral tablets or insulin) consistently as directed.
- Never skip doses without consulting your doctor.
- Monitor blood sugar levels regularly to track effectiveness.
- Be aware of symptoms of low (hypoglycemia) or high (hyperglycemia) blood sugar.
- Keep regular follow-up appointments with healthcare providers.

Note: These are general guidelines. Always consult a healthcare professional for personalized advice based on your condition and medical history.